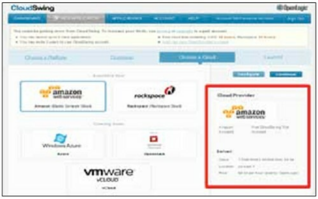

Figure 1: Cloud service providers

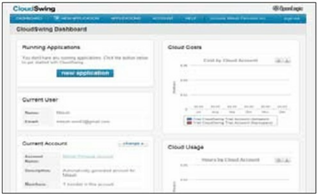

Figure 2: The CloudSwing Dashboard

OpenLogic, is a flexible and open PaaS cloud solution, offering cost-tracking and complete customisation of technology stacks. It also lets you deploy any application on any technology stack to any cloud (as of now, Amazon and RackSpace), creating a flexible Platform-as-a-Service. It includes pre-built open source stacks for Java, Ruby, JavaScript, PHP and other languages. Users can modify or customise these stacks to include any software components they choose, including open source and proprietary software.

CloudSwing offers a free plan for up to three members, in which you can deploy up to five concurrent applications; each user can be a member of one or more CloudSwing accounts.

The pre-built platform options are LAMP, Tomcat, Rails, Node.js and NGinX. OpenLogic provides support for over 600 open source packages. Developers can choose language and platform stacks, and pick all the stack components from the Web framework and the application server to the database.

Built-in management and monitoring of the health of your cloud-based applications comes via OpenLogic's partnering with New Relic; all the pre-built CloudSwing stacks include New Relic monitoring agents. A Cost Management module tracks cloud costs to ensure you stay within your budget.

CloudSwing will offer a choice of infrastructure (cloud, OS and virtualisation technology), though as of now, OS and virtualisation technology choices are not available—at least in free usage. Portability features allow developers to move data, scripts and applications to other PaaS or IaaS offerings.

Deploying a simple Java Web application

Here is the procedure to deploy a simple Java Web application created in Struts + Spring + Hibernate:

1. Register at *https://cloudswing.openlogic.com/* to use the free 30 cloud hours to deploy a Java application.
2. Choose the Platform option to start; select the Tomcat stack to deploy the Java application.
3. Add the Java Web application and/or other components to the pre-built stack, in the Customise Tomcat Platform step.
4. Select the cloud service provider, as seen in Figure 1 -- currently Amazon and RackSpace are available.
5. Launch the Virtual Machine. Once the VM is available, get its IP address, and download the SSH key, which is required to access remote resources from your machine.
6. Navigate to the VM's IP address in a browser, to check that Tomcat is working.
7. Use SCP or your preferred transfer method to upload the application WAR file from your local machine to the remote machine.
8. Connect to the same machine with a MySQL client, and create the database and tables necessary for your application.
9. Configure your application to use the new database; change the host, user name and password in the *database.properties* file (or wherever your application expects to find this configuration).
10. Run the application (after connecting to it in a browser) and check that it works.
11. Figure 2 shows the CloudSwing Dashboard page, where you can monitor applications, apart from cloud usage and costs.

According to Gartner, enterprise software users and vendors currently without a cloud-computing strategy must anticipate that, during the next three years, PaaS offerings will become a strategic part of their technology portfolio, and hence they should plan accordingly. Although the adoption of PaaS is essential in the long term, investment in it must be done with caution, strategic thinking and tactical decision-making. END

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